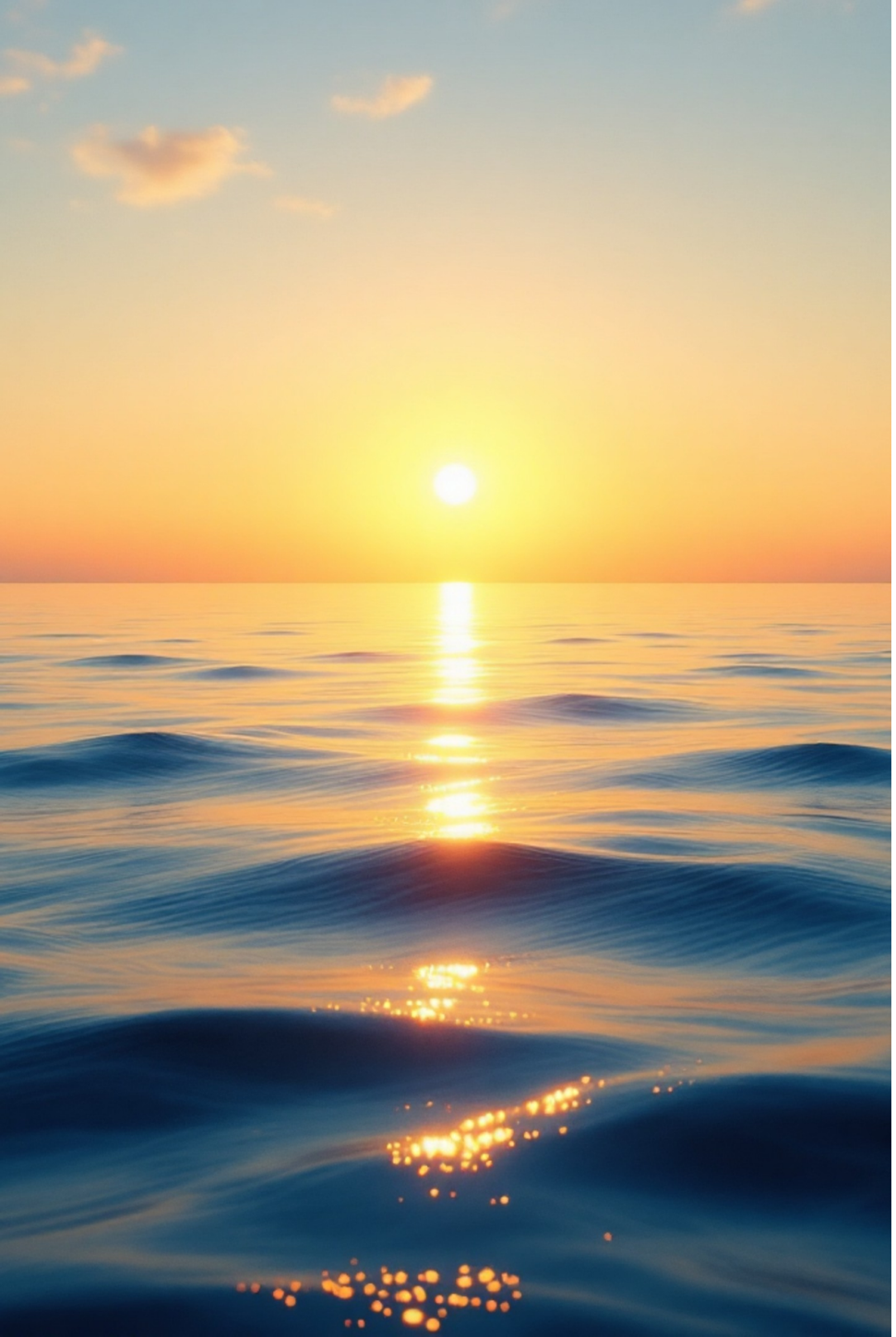


Bipolar Disorder: Building Stability Through Understanding

An 8-lesson psychoeducation course on managing bipolar I, II, and cyclothymia with evidence-based strategies

Beyond "Mood Swings"

Bipolar disorder is far more than everyday mood swings. It's a serious, chronic mental health condition involving distinct episodes of mania (or hypomania) and depression that can profoundly disrupt your life.

A Serious Condition

Bipolar disorder involves clinically distinct mood episodes — not simply feeling "up" or "down" from day to day. These episodes can last days, weeks, or months and significantly impair functioning.

Chronic but Manageable

While bipolar disorder is lifelong, it is highly treatable. With the right combination of medication, therapy, and lifestyle strategies, most people achieve meaningful stability.

Understanding Is Power

Research consistently shows that psychoeducation — learning about your condition — is one of the strongest predictors of long-term stability and reduced relapse rates.

The Bipolar Spectrum

Bipolar disorder is not a single diagnosis — it exists on a spectrum. Understanding where you fall helps guide the most effective treatment and self-management approach.

Bipolar I

Full manic episodes lasting **7+ days** with significant impairment. May include psychosis. Depressive episodes are common but not required for diagnosis.

Bipolar II

Hypomanic episodes that are **less severe and shorter** than full mania, paired with major depressive episodes that are often the dominant feature.

Cyclothymia

Chronic fluctuation between mild highs and lows over at least two years. Symptoms don't meet full criteria for mania or major depression but still disrupt daily life.

Mixed Features

Simultaneous symptoms of mania and depression — feeling energized yet hopeless, or racing thoughts alongside profound sadness. Often the most distressing presentation.

What You'll Learn

This 8-lesson course covers the full landscape of bipolar self-management — from understanding your diagnosis to building a personalized crisis plan.

01

Understand the Spectrum

The differences between Bipolar I, II, cyclothymia, and mixed features — and what each means for your daily life.

02

Track Your Mood

How to monitor mood, sleep, energy, and irritability to identify early warning signs before episodes escalate.

03

CBT Skills

Cognitive-behavioral techniques to challenge extreme beliefs and unhelpful thinking patterns during mood episodes.

04

Daily Rhythm Stabilization

Using Interpersonal and Social Rhythm Therapy (IPSRT) to anchor your biology through consistent daily routines.

05

Managing Depression

Behavioral activation strategies to counter withdrawal, low motivation, and the pull of depressive episodes.

06

Mania Harm Reduction

Recognizing early hypomania and mania, and using practical strategies to reduce risk before episodes take hold.

07

Medication Adherence

Understanding why consistent medication use is the cornerstone of stability — and how to address common barriers.

08

Relapse Prevention

Building a personalized relapse prevention and crisis plan you can rely on when things get difficult.

The Power of Routine

Research shows that **stabilizing daily routines** — consistent sleep/wake times, regular meals, and structured activity — is one of the most effective non-medication strategies for preventing mood episodes.

This approach, formalized as **Interpersonal and Social Rhythm Therapy (IPSRT)**, works by regulating the biological rhythms that underpin mood stability. Disruptions to routine — even positive ones like travel or celebrations — can trigger episodes in vulnerable individuals.

> Consistent sleep timing is the single most protective routine behavior for people with bipolar disorder.

Sleep Consistency

Same bedtime and wake time every day — even weekends.

Regular Meals

Eating at consistent times stabilizes energy and mood.

Structured Activity

Planned movement and social contact anchor your day.

Course Structure

A self-paced, evidence-based program designed to work *alongside* your professional treatment — not as a replacement for it.

8

Lessons

Structured modules covering every aspect of bipolar self-management

8-10

Hours Total

Flexible, self-paced learning you can fit around your life

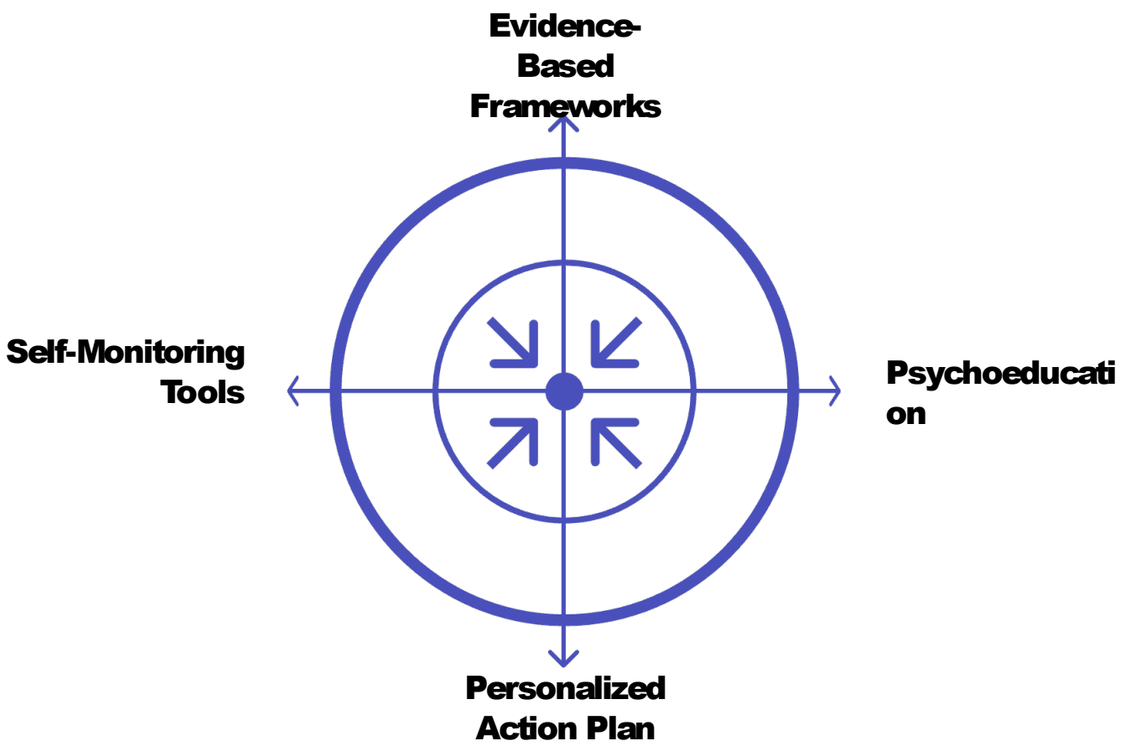
3

Frameworks

Grounded in CBT, IPSRT, and structured self-monitoring

What This Course Is

- Psychoeducation grounded in clinical research
- A complement to medication and professional therapy
- A practical toolkit for daily self-management
- Self-paced and accessible on your schedule

What This Course Is Not

- A replacement for psychiatric care or medication
- A crisis intervention service
- A diagnostic tool
- One-size-fits-all — personalization is built in